



CHASING BIG GOALS: Students on the campus of ISB, Hyderabad

Only **75** of the 2,000 B-schools are able to secure dream jobs for their students.

schools land up with salaries between Rs 6,000-8,000 per month. Most of these 2,000 schools are "quite pathetic", says Choudhary. Professor D.N. Rao, director at the Centre for Management Education, All India Management Association, says that if a gradation of the B-schools were to be carried out, the top 75-100 would be extremely top quality, the rest of the 300-400 would be fairly good and the remaining, mostly comprising schools in small towns, would leave a lot to be desired. These are plagued by poor quality of faculty, students and infrastructure. "There has been proliferation of MBA colleges over the past few years. They provide substandard education and are just made for profiteering purposes. They have diluted the brand image of MBA," says Sasmit Patra, professor and spokesperson, Xavier Institute of Management, Bhubaneswar. Consequently, though there are large number of MBAs in the market only a few have the skills to perform and

succeed in the long run.

Of the 2-2.5 lakh MBA students churned out each year, 10 per cent receive average monthly salaries of Rs 70,000-80,000, 35-40 per cent receive Rs 25,000-40,000 and the rest get in the range of Rs 10,000-15,000 per month. "Even then," says Rao, "it is value for money because they are getting some sales jobs."

"The only solution to the problem," says Professor K.T. Chacko, director, Indian Institute of Foreign Trade (IIFT), Delhi, "is to increase the reach of good institutes". It is not true that every good student will always get a good B-school, he adds. For instance, IIFT shut down its second campus in Dubai two years ago and opened it in Kolkata instead because it realised that good quality students were settling for second-grade schools.

The moral of the story: student attitudes might be changing somewhat although money is still an important consideration. While an MBA is definitely good, all MBAs are not. ■